

A-game in skins whenever playing in a tournament.

A couple of months ago, we also did a cover story, where we interviewed, zipel, a Danish skins collector and trader, who has made a name for himself, and quite a lot of money too, just by trading skins. During the interview, zipel remarked, "Investing in skins is insanely viable. Historically, there is only a really short window of time where you could have bought a diversified amount of different skins and be down money today."

"Basically, anything with limited supply that's old and still have high demand should perform well over time," he added.

Skins quickly became one of the only reasons that people would even sign-up to play CS:GO. While this wasn't the worst thing for Valve, the sh** hit the ceiling when it came to surface that people had



Hey doggo, I have found(ed) a new site!
It's called CS:GO Lotto

been gambling with skins (which was against Valve's TOS), and worse, defrauding people of their skins by indulging in unlawful acts.

To combat this, Valve added a 7-day trade cooldown on all the freshly obtained and traded skins in 2018 while also sending cease and desist notices to the owners of the gambling websites. Gambling bots with hundreds of thousands of dollars' worth of skins were banned. This move practically kill the gambling scene, while trading continued.

In the same year that skins were introduced, Valve also launched the very first CS:GO operation, by the

name of Operation Vanguard. As it was during that operation, and also continues till date, the players had to buy a pass that granted them access to a series of new game modes and objectives to complete.



SOURCE: VALVE

Upon the completion of those objectives, the players were awarded with XP bonuses, skins, and cases.

Over the years, the game has seen the release of 11 operations, with the latest one being Operation Riptide. While each operation has done more good than harm to the popularity of the game, one thing has been annoying the player base. It is the decreasing frequency of the operation releases. The gap between the release of two operations, from being just a few months in 2015-16, has gone up to a year to year and a half in the recent times. Valve, please fix.

PRO-PLAY

Where do we start with talking about the professional players of CS:GO. We have all tried to replicate their epic plays and smoke line-up in the game, only to learn that their level of confidence is something you only get with hard work. Or to better say, playing the game in excess of 20,000 hours.

The professional players and the international tournaments of Counter Strike: Global Offensive have been a facet of the game that no one can get past. If you are talking about CS:GO, then the pro scene CS scene has to be mentioned. At the start, things were a little slow though.

There was a powerhouse team, NiP, Ninjas in Pyjamas, who have to their name till this day, a record streak of winning 87 consecutive games of CS:GO at the highest level. No one came close. Until they met their Swedish rivals, Fnatic at the first major tournament. They served to the fans, a major upset at the very first Counter Strike: Global Offensive in 2013. And the CS:GO pro scene began. More rosters than ever started taking interest in the game, moving from Source or 1.6. Big sporting teams like FaZe clan, and Na'Vi also brought in the best rosters in the world, and the world saw the rise of CS:GO's very own pro-scene.

There have been legendary plays like Coldzera's jumping 4k on Mirage, and the infamous Olof boost, and that diffuse on Overpass. There have been redemption stories like that of Cloud9 at the E-League Boston 2018 Major, and the famous 2017 Kraków Major win for Gambit. Legends have like s1mple, Guardian, KennyS, Olofmeister, NiKo and the like, have come and gone. But the spirits have soared high for every tournament.

Since the first major to the one held in Antwerp this year, year-on-

